FIIB
Enter to Learn, Leave to Succeed

Consumer Behaviour Insights [MKT01]

Consumer Decision Making Process

In-Depth Study of Purchase Decisions

Learning Team - 2



Gargi Das • Arjya Biraj Mishra • Pawan Jha • Dushyant • Govind • Nikhil Kumar

Executive Summary

Research Overview

- 6 In-Depth Interviews Conducted
- 3 Product Categories
- Real Consumer Purchase Decisions
- CDMP Framework Used

Key Findings

Category A → Impulse Decision
Category B → Rational Decision
Category C → Emotional Decision
Digital Platforms Influence All Purchases

Category	Respondent	Product
Category A	Prajval	Protein Bar
Category A	Bhavya	Chai
Category B	Abhisek	Gym Bench
Category B	Guru Pada Das	Washing Machine
Category C	Nidhi	DSLR
Category C	Amruta	Gold Bracelet

"Consumer decisions are not linear they vary by involvement, emotion, and context."

Problem Statement





Understanding Real Consumer Decision Making

Consumer decision-making is often explained through structured models like the Consumer Decision Making Process (CDMP). However, in reality, consumer decisions vary significantly based on:

- Product type
- Level of involvement
- Emotional vs rational motivation
- Influence of digital platforms and social factors

Research Objective

Understand how consumers make purchase decisions across:

- Category A - Mundane Products (<₹200)
- Category B - Utilitarian Products (>₹10,000)
- Category C - Expressive Products (>₹10,000)

Research Questions

- What triggered purchase?
- Who influenced decision?
- How alternatives evaluated?
- Where did consumer buy?

Methodology

5-Step Methodology

- ***Respondent Selection***
  6 Respondents (2 per category)
- ***Depth Interviews***
  30-60 minute interviews
- ***CDMP Analysis***
  Problem → Search → Evaluation → Purchase
- ***Internal & External Factors***
  Personality, Family, Reference Group
- ***Comparative Analysis***
  Category wise comparison



Category A - Findings (Mundane Products)

Prajval
Yoga Protein Bar (₹29 on Blinkit)
Trigger: **No breakfast**
Influence: **Instagram**
Decision: **Low involvement**
Platform: **Blinkit**

Bhavya
Chai + Snack(₹45 Offline Stall)
Trigger: **Situational**
Influence: **Environment**
Decision: **Impulse**

Need

Purchase

Low involvement
Minimal information search
Quick decision making



Category B - Findings (Utilitarian Products)





High involvement
Multiple alternatives evaluated
Rational and functional decision making

Abhisek — Gym Bench (₹15,002 | Amazon)

Trigger: **Need for home workout setup**
Influence: **Brother's recommendation**
Information Search: **Compared multiple brands**
Decision Type: **High involvement**
Platform: **Amazon**
Insight: **Functional and rational decision making**

Guru Pada Das — Washing Machine (~₹45,000 | Retail Store)

Trigger: **Need for household convenience**
Influence: **Wife and family discussion**
Information Search: **Brand comparison**
Decision Type: **Planned purchase**
Platform: **Offline Retail Store**
Insight: **Family-driven utilitarian decision**

Category C - Findings (Expressive Products)

Nidhi — Sony DSLR Camera (₹88,000 | Online)

Trigger: **Passion for photography**
Influence: **Personal interest & online reviews**
Information Search: **Extensive research & comparisons**
Decision Type: **Emotional + rational**
Platform: **Online purchase**
Insight: **Identity-driven purchase**

Amruta — Gold Bracelet (₹49,804 | Jewellery Store)

Trigger: **Gift for father**
Influence: **Emotional motivation**
Information Search: **Brand trust & design comparison**
Decision Type: **Emotional purchase**
Platform: **Jewellery store**
Insight: **Emotion-driven decision**



High emotional involvement
Brand trust important
Identity and meaning influence decision



Comparative Analysis

Factor	Category A (Mundane)	Category B (Utilitarian)	Category C (Expressive)
Involvement Level	Low	High	Emotional / High
Information Search	Minimal	Extensive	Moderate
Decision Type	Impulse / Habitual	Rational / Planned	Emotional + Rational
Key Influence	Price & Convenience	Features & Performance	Identity & Emotion
Decision Process	Collapsed CDMP	Extended CDMP	Emotional CDMP

Consumer decision-making varies based on involvement level and emotional significance:
Category A → Quick, low-risk decisions
Category B → Functional and rational decisions
Category C → Emotion-driven identity decisions

Business Insights & Conclusion

Key Insights

Category A — Mundane Products

Low involvement decisions driven by convenience and availability

Category B — Utilitarian Products

High involvement decisions driven by functionality and comparison

Category C — Expressive Products

Emotion-driven decisions influenced by identity and meaning

Marketing Implications

Build early awareness
Focus on trust
EMI improves conversion



- Digital platforms dominate decision making
- Category A decisions are impulse driven
- Category B decisions are rational
- Category C decisions are emotional

Final Conclusion

Consumer Decision Making is shaped by Involvement, Emotion and Product Type

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Thank You

"Understanding consumer decision-making helps marketers design better strategies across product categories."

